

although it is likely. If these Gamma rays do hit our planet, the surface would turn smouldering hot, wiping out all surface life. Do note that the WR104 is not to be confused with the Betelgeuse debacle that happened a few years ago. While Betelgeuse has been conclusively proven as harmless, WR104 is very much a real threat.

How to survive

The only sure shot way to survive this incident would be to colonise the bottom of our oceans. And we mean like a mass-scale colonisation, move all surface life to the bottom. The depth and the water would shield anything down there from the gamma ray burst. Another way to survive this would be to send to the bottom of the ocean a “Noah’s Arc” of our times, so that once the surface of the planet has calmed down, the planet can be repopulated, although this scenario is unlikely as radiation would take several centuries to reduce to non-toxic levels.

Why it may not happen

The primary reason scientists are sceptical about this occurrence is because what they are observing right now is data that has travelled some 8000 light years. So it’s old. For all we know, WR104 might have shifted its axis, now pointing in a new direction, which the earth is not in the way of anymore.



Polar ice dissipation

Chalk this one up to global warming. We’ve already noted that this planet’s getting pretty hot. Global surface temperatures have risen by about a degree over the last two centuries, and while that may not seem like much in figures, we’re all aware of how it’s been effecting the weather. Summers have become hotter, winters colder, the timeline for weather has become totally skewed and we’re seeing more natural disasters happen now than ever before. However, the one

aspect we’re missing out on is the dissipating polar ice caps. Environment activists have been ranting and raving about the polar bears losing their habitat, but we were far more focussed on other things. Well, now the polar caps are melting significantly and the water level is rising. Currently, it is estimated that the Antarctic ice cap is equivalent to about 30 million cubic kilometres of water. Where do you think all this water is going to go once the ice caps melt?

How to survive

Learn to Surf, Stock up on tons of summer and winter clothing that would be accessible at an instant’s notice. Also, you’re going to have to make all your belongings “floatable”, and make sure everything is water resistant. Last we checked, cats hated to swim, so if you have a pet cat, you might want to do something about it.

Why it may not happen

The massive chunk of the polar ice caps is still frozen solid, so unless there is a massive heat ray unleashed by a villain, the polar ice caps will not be melting all the way soon enough to fulfil the Mayan “prophecy.”



Super volcanos

Bet you didn’t know about these bad boys. A super volcano is to regular (most violent noted) volcanos what a nuclear weapon is to a firecracker. A super volcano will contain anywhere around a few hundred million times more lava than the one spewed out in the eruption of Mt. St. Helen in the United States. Once a supervolcano goes off, it is hypothesized that it would continue to erupt for days, sending lava and ash



Earth's just getting a core transplant. no big deal

into the air for days, before calming down into a stage where the magma just pouts out the crater. Essentially, each one is a global catastrophic event. Currently there are 7 known supervolcanos around the world, with the most active threat being the Yellowstone Caldera, located in Yellowstone National Park.

The last time the Yellowstone Caldera exploded, it was 640,000 years ago and ejected about 1000 cubic kilometres of rock, dust and volcanic ash into the air. In the last 2.1 million years, the caldera has gone violent three times and the scientific community is divided on whether its over-due for a fourth episode or not. However, given that between 2004-2008, the Yellowstone Plateau rose by upwards by almost 3 inches per year, which is three times greater than ever observed.

How to survive

If you live in the vicinity of the supervolcano (Wyoming, Idaho, Washington, Oregon) then you are in the immediate danger zone. Get the hell out! Once the supervolcano erupts, it will eject dust, ash and rock into the air, which will make the air unbreathable because when the ash-rock combination inhaled mixes with the moisture in the lungs, it will turn to cement, causing you to drown internally. The rock-ash would also render all electronic equipment useless due to their conductivity. Surviving this horrible disaster would require careful planning. Building a shielded shelter will be of utmost importance along with figuring out how to develop an air filtration system. Of course, stocking up on food and rations will also become absolutely essential. We recommend you not panic and grab a wet towel. **[4]**